

watching OTT, why should that subscription be individual?” he argues. “You have only one electricity connection in the house. You don’t pay by room. Then why should content not be a shared cost for the family?” he asks.

Tata Play wants to turn an STB into an OTT box. “Tata is well-positioned to compete in that space. As far as entertainment consumption goes, the next generation will be cord-cutters. But there’s a lot of life left in TV especially because news is such a big deal in India. That’s the biggest thing that keeps DTH sticky,” says Sinha of Bexley Advisors.

The Indian market has four major pay DTH providers—Videocon d2h, Tata Play, Airtel, and Sun Direct. According to a FICCI-EY report, pay TV will continue to grow as states such as Uttar Pradesh,

A FICCI-EY REPORT SAYS PAY TV WILL CONTINUE TO GROW AS STATES SUCH AS UP, BIHAR, RAJASTHAN AND WEST BENGAL GET ELECTRIFIED

Bihar, Rajasthan and West Bengal get electrified. However, more new users will enter the free TV market as the Free Dish channel count increases to around 200 by 2022 (from 164 in 2021), providing a low-cost advertising opportunity

to marketers, despite the decision of large broadcasters to take their content off the platform in February 2022.

Tata Play’s closest competitor, Airtel, also offers the Xstream Premium box with over 5,000